

Problem 4: Wiradjuri

(20 marks)

Here are some sentences in Wiradjuri⁵ and their corresponding English translations.

inarru burai bume	a woman beat a child
bumalali nal	strike me again
nal bumani dyin	I was struck by him
bumai malang ngin-dyu	I should strike him
inarru wille dharalgiri	a woman will eat an opossum ⁶
ngin yala ngin bumali	tell him to beat him
yalai malang-nga ngin	he should have been told
bumai malang-nga nal	I should have been struck
karia ngin bumalali	let him not be struck again
karia bumalmambia	do not let him strike
bumali ngin-dyu	let me strike him
buma ngin	strike him
mirridu wille bume	a dog beat an opossum

Additionally, note that gibir means “man”.

Assignment 1: (3 marks)

Translate from Wiradjuri:

- (a) karia mirri dharalmambia
- (b) willedu inar bumalgiri
- (c) karia nal buma

⁵Wiradjuri is a language in the Pama-Nyungan family spoken by approximately 1500 people in Australia.

⁶An opossum is a nocturnal marsupial roughly the size of a house cat.

Assignment 2: (5 marks)

Translate into Wiradjuri. If a sentence has multiple possible translations, write at least one.

- (a) tell him again
- (b) eat him
- (c) I should have eaten him
- (d) a man told a child
- (e) a woman was told by an opossum

Assignment 3: (12 marks)

Explain your solution.